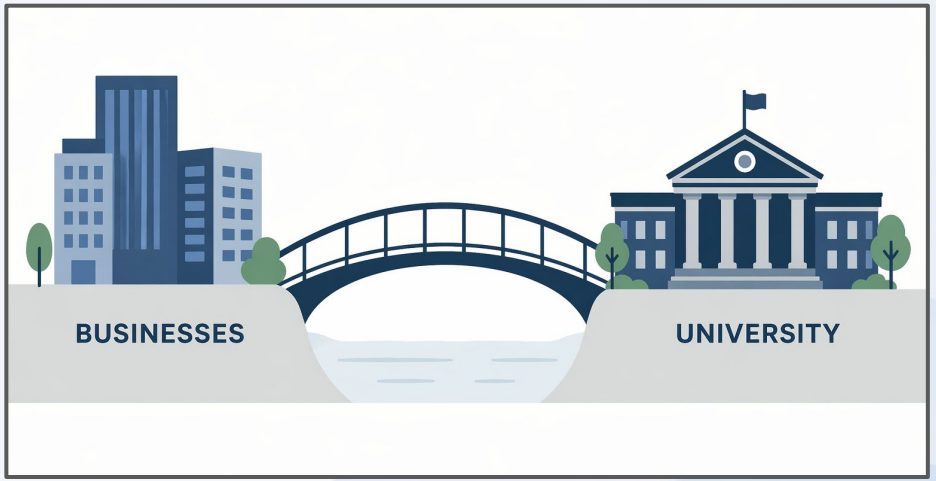
CoBA TalentLink

Corporate Affiliate Program Development

Project Overview

- Senior Experience program lacks lasting relationships
- Affiliate program would commit businesses on a yearly basis
- Additional access to talent for participants
- Additional revenue for CoBA at little cost



Project Proposal

- Extensive research
- Corporate affiliate program framework
- Marketable brochure
- Detailed Report



Secondary Research

- Research existing university programs
- Tried to stay within budget and school size of CSUSM
- Prices were between $1K-$6K per year
- **Recommendation:** Create a tiered partnership model

CALIFORNIA STATE UNIVERSITY LONG BEACH

COLORADO STATE UNIVERSITY

MIRACOSTA COLLEGE

CALIFORNIA STATE UNIVERSITY CHICO

SAN DIEGO STATE UNIVERSITY

Drafting the Brochure

- Mira Costa “Business Roundtable”
- 3 pages: Intro, Selling Points, Tiers and Prices
- Built with Google Docs, visually quite rudimentary
- Supervisors were relatively pleased at the conclusion of this objective…



CSUSM

BECOME AN AFFILIATE **TODAY**

Interested in pursuing an affiliate-style relationship with CoBA at CSUSM?

Take THIS SURVEY to help our team better serve you in the future!

☐ Executive Partner
$7,500 / year:

- 1 senior and 1 masters experience project included (or 2 senior experience)
- 1 included private recruiting event (held on campus)
- Priority access to student candidate lists and internship placements
- Prominent logo display on CoBA website, event signage, and social media promotion
- Top-priority access for senior experience project submissions
- Invitation to serve on industry advisory panels or mentorship initiatives
- Invitation to community
- Recognition as a lead CoB
- Sponsorship of the Senior

☐ Strategic Partner
$5,000 / year:

- 2 senior experience project
- Reserved participation in C
- Company logo featured on
- Featured spotlight in CoBA
- Invitation to community le
- Guest speaking opportuniti
- Priority access to project pa
- Early notice of internship a

☐ Affiliate Partner
$2,500 OR
$1,000* / year:

- 1 included Senior Experien
- Participation in CoBA netw
- Invitation to community le
- Company logo or name list
- Early notice of internship a
- **For qualifying nonprofit bu*

☐ Add-Ons
(for any tier):

- Additional Senior Experien
- Additional Masters Experie
- Private student recruiting e
- Classroom workshop or gu

To become an official affiliate partner of CSUSM, p
To get more detailed information, please contact

CSUSM

ALL-NEW COLLEGE OF BUSINESS INITIATIVE: CORPORATE AFFILIATE **PARTNERSHIPS**

Why Partner With CoBA?

CSUSM's College of Business Administration (CoBA) is AACSB-accredited (top ~6% globally) and serves over 3,500 business students in high-demand fields like finance, marketing, and supply chain. With a strong focus on career readiness and hands-on learning, CoBA produces graduates equipped with real-world experience through internships, consulting projects, and capstone courses—making it a valuable talent pipeline for employers.

AACSB ACCREDITED

CoBA's Senior and Masters Experience Programs

In the past, CoBA's senior and masters experience programs have provided students with much-needed real-world experience in their final semesters of respective degrees, while providing businesses of all sizes with affordable, consulting-style services. Until now, these programs have taken projects on a case-by-case basis, with no strings attached, and project prices start at $1,500 and vary depending on the scope, scale, and specialization.

Developed by Students

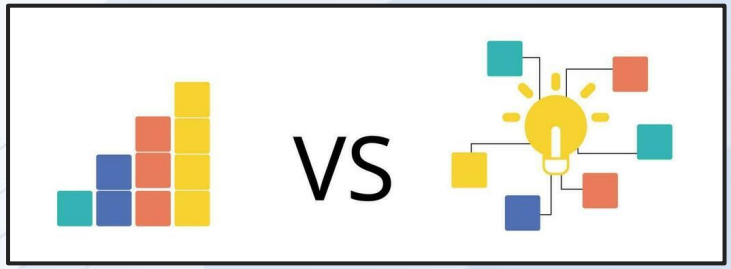
The CoBA affiliate program was actually designed *by students* as part of their senior experience project. As a direct product of the program itself, this work reflects the professional standards, rigor, and real-world readiness that define CoBA students. The program was built to create meaningful and mutually beneficial partnerships by connecting employers with capable students and university resources while also supporting career-focused education.

Join Us in Educating the Next Generation

Partnering with CoBA means investing in the future workforce while gaining meaningful access to emerging talent. Join a growing network of employers committed to developing students, strengthening the business community, and building long-term recruiting pipelines.

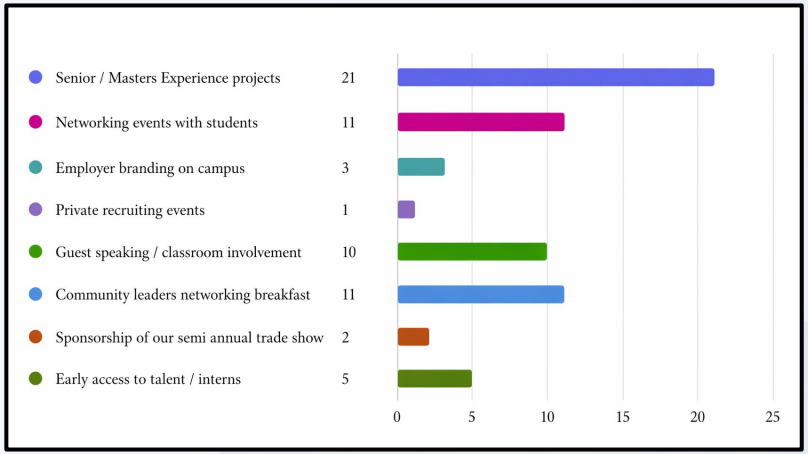
Primary Research

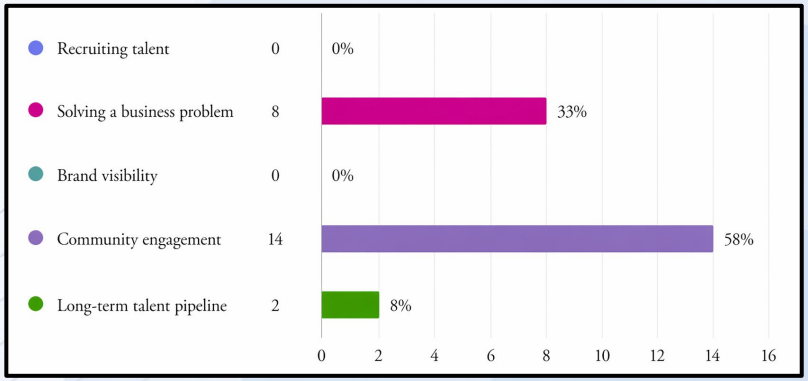
- Email list from Giselle Bazan (2023 onward - 340 contacts)
- Microsoft Forms survey
- Interviews with local professionals
- Goal of sourcing **both** quantitative and subjective/opinionated data



Microsoft Forms Survey

- Quantitative data collection
- 24 responses
- 88% valued student projects as a top benefit
- Community engagement was leading motivation





Individual Interviews

- Personal and nuanced data collection
- 15 total interviews conducted
  - 7 Nonprofit businesses
  - 5 Small businesses
  - 3 Large businesses
- Wealth of knowledge, even with 1 or 2 profound points per interview

Vista Teen Outreach

VALLECITOS WATER DISTRICT
Water and Wastewater Specialists since 1955

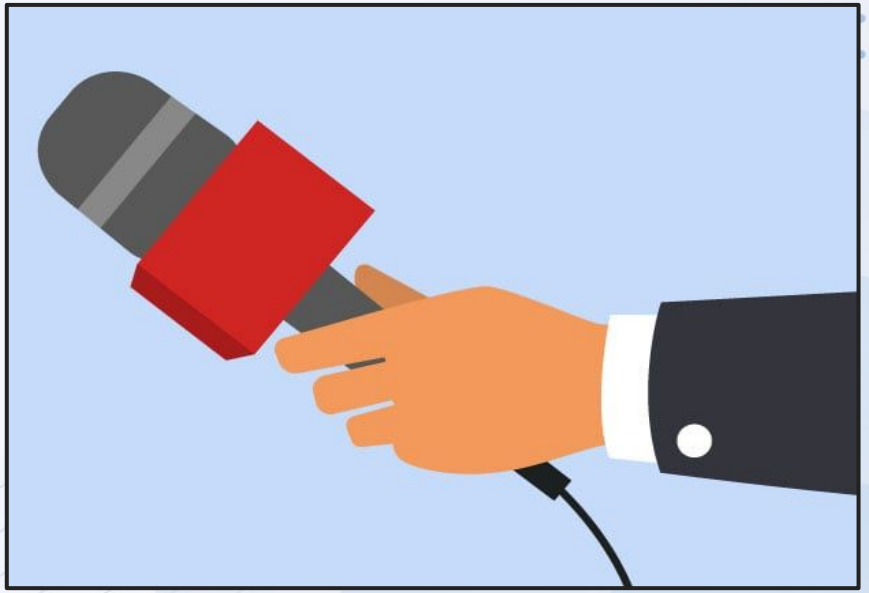


SAN DIEGO FOOD BANK EST. 1977

California State University SAN MARCOS

Key Takeaways from Interviews

- Professional quality visuals are important to everyone
- Different businesses will view the same terms completely differently
- Nonprofits are not a primary target
- The project is the program



Updating the Brochure

- Interview feedback continuously pointed us to update
- Would this get someone to stop and read?
- Cut to two pages for printability
- Fresh marketable name: TalentLink
- First draft repurposed for web materials



ALL-NEW CoBA TalentLink

California State University SAN MARCOS
COLLEGE OF BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION

CORPORATE AFFILIATE PARTNERSHIPS!

Official Branding

Why Invest in Our Students?

We provide the **#1 Student Experience** among universities in San Diego, Riverside, and Orange County (Wall Street Journal, 2025).

We're also in the **Top 1% in Social Mobility** nationwide, out of more than 1,200 schools (CollegeNET 2023)

Our Senior Experience Program

The **Senior Experience** is a semester-long, course in which student teams work directly with organizations to address real business challenges. The structure is designed to give businesses influence in the education of the next generation, and the majority of students at CoBA are first-generation.

Fast Facts

- 5-student project teams
- **750 Project Hours** provided
- Special pricing available for nonprofit businesses
- Multi-semester project submissions possible
- **30-year-old program**
- 2,200+ projects completed for sponsoring businesses
- **10,000 Business Students** have completed the capstone program
- 40% of projects completed for non-profit organizations
- Over half our participants are **Repeat Sponsors**
- Past sponsors have ranged from 1-person startups to Fortune 100 companies

CoBA TalentLink Benefits

Overall Conciceness

Senior and Masters Experience Projects
Collaborate with student teams on real business challenges and get unique and fresh viewpoints from young minds.

Priority Recruiting Access
Gain early and direct access to a pipeline of qualified CoBA students and graduates before they enter the broader job market.

Key Info Highlighted

Participation in Networking Events
Engage directly with students and other businesses at BUS 300 networking nights, allowing you to build relationships, identify talent early, and promote your company culture.

Private Recruiting Events on Campus
Host exclusive, target recruiting events designed specifically for your organization, creating a focused environment to connect with high-potential candidates.

Our Student Employers

Custom Borders

GENERAL ATOMICS AERONAUTICAL
illumina
ThermoFisher SCIENTIFIC
NORTHROP GRUMMAN
LPL Financial
WELLS FARGO
Viasat
Qualcomm
Hunter

Whitespace Reduction

Become an official TalentLink Affiliate TODAY!

California State University SAN MARCOS
COLLEGE OF BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION

College of Business Administration

Executive Partner
$7,500 / year

- **1 Senior and 1 Masters Experience project** included (or 2 Senior Experience)
- 1 included **Private Recruiting Event** (held on campus)
- Priority access to student candidate lists and internship placements
- Prominent **Logo Display** on CoBA website, event signage, and social media promotion
- Top-priority access for senior experience project submissions
- Invitation to serve on industry advisory panels or mentorship initiatives
- Recognition as a lead CoBA affiliate partner
- Sponsorship of the **Senior Experience Tradeshow**

All Benefits Listed at the Strategic Tier are Available at the Executive Tier

Strategic Partner
$5,000 / year

- **2 Senior Experience projects** included
- Reserved participation in CoBA **Student and Business Networking** events
- Company logo featured on event signage and promotional materials
- **Featured Spotlight** in CoBA newsletter/email push
- Invitation to community leaders networking breakfast
- **Guest Speaking Opportunities** in relevant classes
- Priority access to project proposal submissions
- Early notice of **Internship and Entry-level Talent Availability**

All Benefits Listed at the Affiliate Tier are Available at the Strategic Tier

Affiliate Partner
$2,500 Or $1,000* / year

- 1 included **Senior Experience project**
- Participation in CoBA networking events
- Invitation to **Community Leaders Networking Breakfast**
- Company logo shown on the CoBA affiliate webpage
- Early notice of internship and entry-level talent availability
- * For qualifying nonprofit businesses, CoBA offers a significant discount (free project)

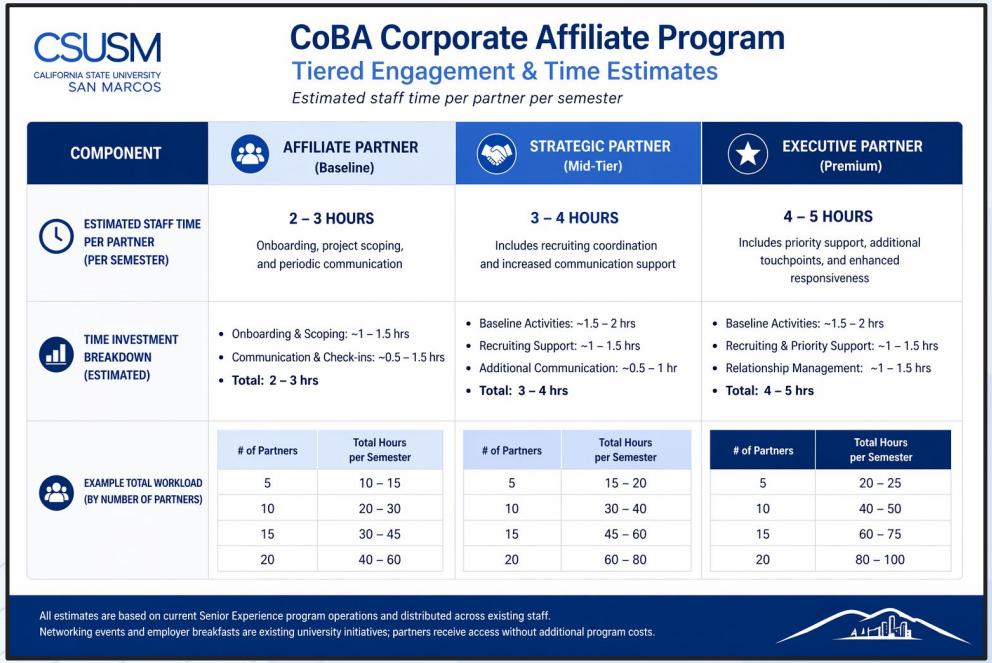
Program Add-Ons (available to all tiers)

Additional Senior Experience project	$1,500 per project
Additional Masters Experience project	$2,500 specialized $5,000 Fully Employed
Private student recruiting event:	$1,000
Classroom workshop or guest lecture series	$500

To become an **Official Affiliate Partner** of CSUSM, please contact Sara Vaz at svaz@csusm.edu
To get more **Detailed Information**, please contact Roger Herzler at rherzler@csusm.edu

CoBA's Implementation

- Built on existing infrastructure
- Low operational cost, high scalability
- Tiered system aligns engagement with support
- Minimal setup costs



CSUSM
CALIFORNIA STATE UNIVERSITY
SAN MARCOS

CoBA Corporate Affiliate Program

Tiered Engagement & Time Estimates

Estimated staff time per partner per semester

COMPONENT	AFFILIATE PARTNER (Baseline)	STRATEGIC PARTNER (Mid-Tier)	EXECUTIVE PARTNER (Premium)
ESTIMATED STAFF TIME PER PARTNER (PER SEMESTER)	**2 – 3 HOURS** Onboarding, project scoping, and periodic communication	**3 – 4 HOURS** Includes recruiting coordination and increased communication support	**4 – 5 HOURS** Includes priority support, additional touchpoints, and enhanced responsiveness
TIME INVESTMENT BREAKDOWN (ESTIMATED)	• Onboarding & Scoping: ~1 – 1.5 hrs • Communication & Check-ins: ~0.5 – 1.5 hrs • **Total: 2 – 3 hrs**	• Baseline Activities: ~1.5 – 2 hrs • Recruiting Support: ~1 – 1.5 hrs • Additional Communication: ~0.5 – 1 hr • **Total: 3 – 4 hrs**	• Baseline Activities: ~1.5 – 2 hrs • Recruiting & Priority Support: ~1 – 1.5 hrs • Relationship Management: ~1 – 1.5 hrs • **Total: 4 – 5 hrs**
EXAMPLE TOTAL WORKLOAD (BY NUMBER OF PARTNERS)			

# of Partners	Total Hours per Semester
5	10 – 15
10	20 – 30
15	30 – 45
20	40 – 60

# of Partners	Total Hours per Semester
5	15 – 20
10	30 – 40
15	45 – 60
20	60 – 80

# of Partners	Total Hours per Semester
5	20 – 25
10	40 – 50
15	60 – 75
20	80 – 100

All estimates are based on current Senior Experience program operations and distributed across existing staff.
Networking events and employer breakfasts are existing university initiatives; partners receive access without additional program costs.

Recommendations

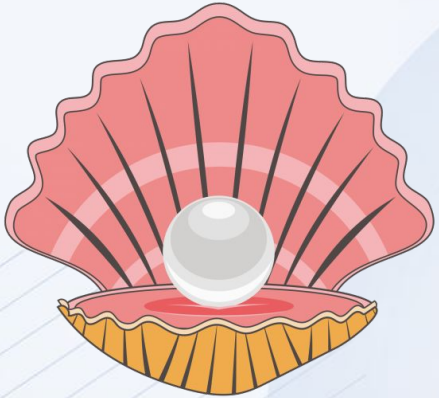
- Tiered pricing with corresponding benefits
- 3 different pitch strategies
  - ➔ Small businesses
  - ➔ Nonprofit businesses
  - ➔ Large businesses
- Extends to email outreach



Lessons Learned



- Thorough communication with those external to team
- Utilization of resources
- Creative Freedom
- Finding our “Pearl”



Conclusion



CoBA TalentLink...

- has been validated in concept through secondary **and** primary research
- Is scalable and sustainable with minimal cost incursion
- Is ready for implementation next semester with a marketable design and sales plan
- Establishes a consistent pipeline between businesses and CoBA students

Thank You For Your Time!

We will now begin a Q&A discussion for those that have questions.